

Katarina Ironside

Character Dossier

Methodical and secretly sentimental fishmonger of the Academy of Vell

Overview

Katarina Ironside is a fishmonger living in the Academy of Vell. Katarina is 24 years old, originally from Halvard, and is known around the Hall of Echoes as methodical and secretly sentimental. In conversation Katarina mutters prices and measurements while thinking.

Background

Katarina arrived in the Academy of Vell 17 years ago after leaving Halvard under circumstances Katarina describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Faculty of Applied Wonders; the second was the one that stuck. Today Katarina works as a fishmonger near the north observatory and is paid, when paid at all, in guilders.

Katarina learned the trade from Dashiell Underhill, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Katarina's life is with Xanthe Blackwater, over a matter neither will explain. The person Katarina trusts most is Fenwick Falkenrath.

Current goal: to map every path through the Hall of Echoes. Greatest fear: birds indoors.

Personality and speech

Temperament: methodical and secretly sentimental.

Speech pattern: Katarina mutters prices and measurements while thinking.

Tells: when lying, Katarina mentions Ollie the lizard for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Katarina Ironside
Role	fishmonger
Home	the Academy of Vell
Hometown	Halvard
Age	24
Favourite dish	hand-rolled black garlic noodles
Pet	Ollie, a lizard
Lucky number	316

<i>Workshop password</i>	saffron-thorn
<i>Mentor</i>	Dashiell Underhill
<i>Rival</i>	Xanthe Blackwater
<i>Closest friend</i>	Fenwick Falkenrath

Secret

Katarina has never told Dashiell Underhill that the famous 'accident' was deliberate.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Katarina: I am the fishmonger. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Katarina: Hand-rolled black garlic noodles. Do not tell Xanthe I said so.

Visitor: Is Ollie yours?

Katarina: Ollie belongs to nobody. Ollie tolerates me. Lucky number is 316, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 19

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Katarina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Katarina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Katarina and Xanthe outside the bell tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Katarina moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Ollie, and wrote three lines to Dashiell about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 2, autumn of year 19

Katarina repaired the tin whistle at the greenhouse cloisters for Baptiste, who paid in 30 guilders and a long story about who really won the regatta. Katarina spent the day counting stock at the greenhouse cloisters: 34 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Katarina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Katarina for the password to the workshop. Katarina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 3, winter of year 19

Dashiell visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Katarina repaired the glass float at the greenhouse cloisters for Caspian, who paid in 25 guilders and a long story about the new curfew. A dispute over the census flared up between Katarina and Xanthe outside the greenhouse cloisters; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.